Choose the good way

Starter lesson 01 · Psalm 1:1–2 · 20 minutes

Read from your Bible: Psalm 1:1–2 in NIV or Good News Bible (GNB).

Lesson summary, not a Bible quotation: God's teaching helps us consider the advice we follow and the choices we make. We can enjoy learning his ways.

Today's learning goal

With a grownup, notice a kind choice and practise listening to God's teaching.

Before the children arrive

Have a Bible, crayons or pencils and these pages ready. Cut the cards on page 5. No internet or special equipment is needed.

A lesson you can lead

3 min **Welcome.** Ask children to show listening ears and kind hands.

3 min **Read.** Read Psalm 1:1–2 aloud in NIV or GNB. Explain one word: delight means enjoying something.

5 min **Discover.** Show the picture choices on page 3. Ask children to point before naming an answer.

5 min **Create.** Colour the open Bible and path on page 4. Talk while colouring.

4 min **Respond.** Choose one action card. Practise it together and pray.

Keep the message caring

Talk about helpful or harmful actions, not "good children" and "bad children". Welcome questions. Explain that we can apologise, ask for help and try again. This passage is not a promise that life will always be easy.

A little time together

A family conversation · 8 minutes · A Bible and a willing grownup

Read, talk and try

2 min Read the passage aloud, then say: God helps us learn good ways to live.

3 min Use two picture choices on page 3. Let your child point, act or speak.

3 min Choose one action card to try today. Pray together.

Questions with room for different answers

What can we enjoy learning?

Grownup guidance: God’s teaching. Accept a gesture towards the Bible.

What can kind hands do?

Grownup guidance: Share, help or welcome. Encourage a specific example.

One practice for the week

Share one toy or crayon today. A grownup can help you take turns.

A prayer to say together

Dear God, thank you for your teaching. Help me listen, be kind and choose a good way today. Amen.

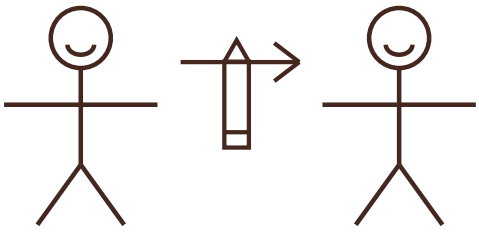
Our family’s idea

What will we try, and when?

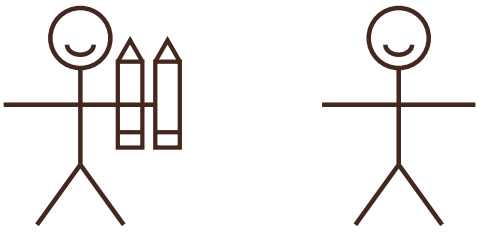
Pause. Think. Choose.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Grownup: read the labels. Ask your child to circle a helpful choice in each row. They can point or act it out instead.



Take turns



Grab all the crayons



Tell someone to go away



Invite someone to play

Show me: listening ears • helping hands • a friendly wave

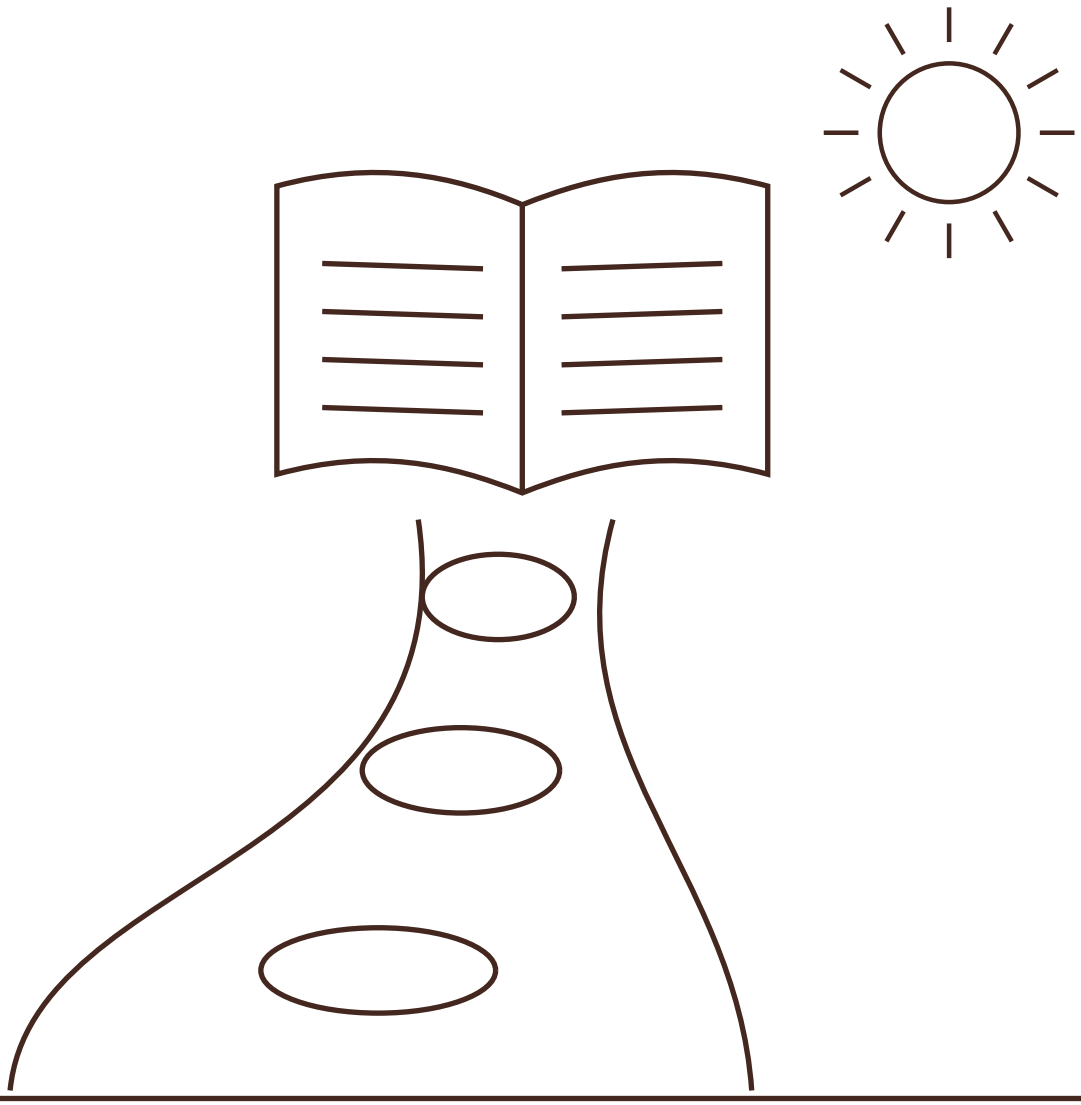
Ask: How might your choice help someone? There may be more than one caring response.

Make your good way

Read Psalm 1:1–2 together before starting.

Colour the Bible, sunshine and path. Draw someone you can help. Tell a grownup about your picture.

My ideas can go anywhere inside this frame.



My next helpful choice: _____

Grownup note: this drawing supports discussion. The path and sun are illustrations, not a picture described in verses 1–2.

Small choices, big care

Grownup: cut on the dotted lines. Pick a card, talk, then practise together.



SHARE

Someone wants a turn with your crayons. What could you do?



WELCOME

A child is playing alone. How could you invite them?



TELL THE TRUTH

You made a mistake. Who could you ask for help?



LISTEN

Someone gives you advice. What could you ask before acting?



ENCOURAGE

A friend is finding a task difficult. What could you say?



LEARN

Choose a time to enjoy a Bible passage with a grownup.

Older children: add a respectful sentence you could actually say. Younger children: let a grownup read and model an action.

Encourage the thinking

Suggested responses and a gentle check in

Page 3: answer guidance

First row: taking turns is helpful. Second row: inviting someone is helpful. Let your child point, speak, sign or act. Ask what the other child might feel. Model a short sentence: “Your turn, then my turn.”

Pages 4 and 5: notice effort

There is no single correct drawing or script. Praise careful thought, willingness to listen and a concrete act of care. Invite children to explain their picture or choice. Support children who prefer pointing, movement or a spoken answer.

A check in after the lesson

What did you notice in the Bible passage?

Which choice will you practise?

Who can help you when you are unsure?

Adapt without pressure

Read aloud as needed. Offer a spoken answer, a drawing or a gesture. Give extra time and a break. In mixed age groups, read together, then use the activity for each child’s stage. An older child can help a younger child without doing the activity for them.

Content note: All explanations and scenarios in this pack are original teaching material. They are not verbatim Scripture. Read Psalm 1:1–2 from a licensed NIV or GNB Bible. Starter pack prepared for review by The Bible Playroom team before use in a class.